



SURGE NEUROTECH HACKATHON

September 18–20, 2026 • Judging Rubric

Scoring Key: Perfect Excellent Proficient Limited *Total: 50 points across 5 categories.*

Category	Perfect (10)	Excellent (8–9)	Proficient (5–7)	Limited (0–4)	Score
Clarity & Structure (/10)	Clear, logical, and well-structured throughout — easy to follow from start to finish.	Clear, logical, and well-structured. Ideas flow smoothly and are easy to follow.	Mostly clear with minor gaps in flow or structure.	Disorganized or difficult to follow.	____ /10
Technical Understanding (/10)	Strong command of the system, pipeline, and methodology — can confidently explain every design choice.	Strong understanding of the system, pipeline, or methodology. Team can explain all components and design choices.	Basic understanding shown; some technical details missing or unclear.	Limited or incorrect explanation of technical aspects.	____ /10
Demonstration or Results (/10)	Demo runs well and clearly shows what it does, or results are presented with clear, thoughtful interpretation.	Demo runs smoothly and clearly shows functionality, or results are clearly presented with compelling visuals and interpretation.	Demo works partially or has issues, or results are present but lack depth or clarity.	Demo missing or fails, or results are absent or unclear.	____ /10
Learning & Reflection (/10)	Thoughtful, well-articulated reflection on what was tried, what worked, and the key lessons learned.	Clearly explains what was tried, what worked or didn't, and articulates key lessons learned.	Some reflection present but limited in depth or specificity.	Little or no reflection on the process or outcomes.	____ /10
Innovation, Impact & Feasibility (/10)	A genuinely innovative, ambitious idea with a feasible approach and strong real-world potential.	Introduces a meaningfully innovative idea or approach that addresses a real problem. The approach is realistic and feasible, and ambition and potential impact are evident.	Some innovation, motivation, or feasibility is shown; scope, impact, or practicality could be stronger.	Lacks clear motivation, innovation, feasibility, or a meaningful application.	____ /10
TOTAL SCORE					____ /50

Stream-Specific Guidance

Brain-Controlled Applications	AI & Machine Learning	Hardware Hacking
Demonstration or Results: Live or pre-recorded demo showing real-time EEG control of an application.	Demonstration or Results: Visualizations, classification results, or statistical findings presented clearly with interpretation.	Demonstration or Results: Live or pre-recorded demo of hardware.